Ke-Cheng Hsu (Clio)
Ph.D. Candidate, Department of Economics, HKUST
(852) 6840 9753 | khsu@connect.ust.hk
cliohsu1997.github.io | github.com/cliohsu1997

October 21, 2026

Hiring Team
RBB Economics — Singapore
Re: #26/27 Application — Economist (Singapore)

Dear Hiring Team,

I am writing to apply for the Economist position in RBB Economics' #26/27 recruitment round, with Singapore as my preferred office. I am a Ph.D. candidate in Economics at HKUST (expected June 2027; I can finish earlier if preferred), with training in microeconomics, industrial organisation, and econometrics. I am a native Mandarin speaker and professionally fluent in English. I am drawn to RBB because the firm focuses solely on competition economics, and I want to contribute to live matters involving mergers, market investigations, pricing, and firm conduct.

The Economist role emphasises researching industry dynamics, trends, and market structures; programming, model building, and regression analysis; applying quantitative and qualitative techniques; and assisting with expert economic reports and presentations for demanding clients on tight deadlines. That is the work I already do. In my job market paper on Taobao apparel return policy, I clean large transaction data, build and estimate models of purchase and return behaviour, run regression and structural analysis, and deliver figures and written results on fixed deadlines. With Professors Kohei Kawaguchi and Kei Kawai, I study pricing and inventory under resale price maintenance using large bookstore point-of-sale records, combining descriptive evidence, regressions, and a dynamic oligopoly model. Ph.D.-level IO coursework included merger simulations, entry/exit counterfactuals, and firm-conduct identification. I communicate clearly in writing and verbally, work well in teams, and pick up new industry detail quickly.

I have attached my CV, this cover letter, and my transcripts. Thank you for your consideration.

Sincerely,

Ke-Cheng Hsu (Clio)